Guilherme Silveira dos Santos

Senior Software Engineer | Go Specialist | Freelancer

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Senior Software Engineer with 15+ years of experience, specializing in backend development with Go, my primary language since 2015. I design and build distributed systems, microservices and event-driven architectures, with experience across fintech and payments, e-commerce and AI platforms.

Comfortable across the stack, from infrastructure (Kubernetes, Terraform, CI/CD) to frontend when needed. I work hands-on with AI agents (Claude, Cursor, Codex) and have built agent skills and AI-powered knowledge bases for engineering and product teams. Open-source contributor to gRPC-Gateway and Elastic's Go client.

I enjoy greenfield projects, from my own ERP and e-invoicing platform to a multi-currency investment tracker, and bring a product mindset, clean code and strong communication skills. Open to freelance and consulting work on Go-based, cloud-native and high-performance backend platforms.

Skills

Go / Golang

Message Broker
Kafka, Pub/Sub, NATS, SQS/SNS, RabbitMQ

Infrastructure / Automation
Terraform, Ansible, bash scripting

CI / CD
GitLab CI, GitHub Actions, Jenkins, CircleCI

Python

Relational Databases
MySQL, MariaDB, Postgres

Cloud Platforms
AWS, GCP, DigitalOcean

AI / LLM
Claude, Cursor, Codex, ChatGPT, AI agents & skills, Prompt engineering, LLM integration, Fine-tuned models

System Design
Event-driven, REST, gRPC, Pub/Sub

NoSQL
MongoDB, Redis, Elasticsearch

Containers / Orchestration
Docker, Kubernetes

Agile Practices
XP, TDD, Scrum, Kanban

Work Experience

Sep 2025 – Present
London, UK

NALA, *Senior Software Engineer*
Working on Rafiki, NALA's B2B cross-border payments platform connecting banks and mobile-money networks. Integrated payment providers across Africa and Asia and optimized performance platform-wide, scaling throughput from 2.5 to 30 TPS (12x). Built AI agent skills that let product managers make small codebase changes themselves, and an AI-powered knowledge base for integrating and maintaining providers. Stack: Go, Postgres, Redis, Kafka, AWS ECS, Prometheus, Grafana, Datadog.

May 2023 – Sep 2025 Palo Alto - CA, USA	**Birdie AI**, *Head of Engineering* Led and restructured the engineering team, rebuilt the entire data pipeline and launched a feedback intelligence platform powered by LLMs (ChatGPT) and fine-tuned custom models. Architected it from scratch as event-driven Go microservices on Google Pub/Sub, Elasticsearch and Postgres. Raised engineering standards and improved delivery processes, enabling scalable AI-powered insights for enterprise customers.
May 2022 – May 2023 Paris, FR	**Qonto**, *Staff Engineer* Defined Go development standards, mentored teams and led the rollout of a scalable, event-driven architecture across Qonto's backend. Worked with cross-functional teams to align technical decisions with business goals in a high-growth fintech.
Jun 2020 – Apr 2022 Berlin, DE	**Zalando**, *Senior Software Engineer* Modernized the Campaign and Content Solution (CCS) platform, replacing a legacy PHP system with Go microservices. Migrated SOAP to RESTful APIs and introduced a Kafka-based, event-driven architecture for scalability and maintainability. Built a critical service for onboarding product articles from partners and internal teams such as logistics and supplier ops.
Mar 2013 – Present	**Giox Tecnologia,** *Founder & Lead Engineer* Founded and built a SaaS ERP for small businesses that evolved into a certified Brazilian e-invoicing platform, owning architecture, full-stack development and DevOps. Re-architected the original PHP monolith into Go and PHP microservices with NSQ and MongoDB, plus a Vue.js/Vuetify SPA on Firebase, with infrastructure managed through Docker, Ansible and GitLab CI.
Nov 2019 – Jun 2020	**ProShare by Volkswagen,** *Senior Software Engineer* Built the backend for a B2B car-sharing platform for professional users within the Volkswagen Group: Go microservices communicating over gRPC, exposing GraphQL and REST APIs to mobile and web clients. Designed and deployed cloud-native infrastructure on AWS with Terraform and Kubernetes.
Jan 2018 – Nov 2019	**DeliveryHero**, *Senior Software Engineer* Key contributor to modernizing Pandora's platform (Foodora + Foodpanda), migrating a legacy PHP monolith to event-driven Go microservices. In Search & Discovery, built a high-traffic API serving four brands in 20 countries, improving average response times 6× with Elasticsearch, Redis and MySQL. Drove Go adoption by defining engineering standards, running training and co-developing an open-source library.
Sep 2016 – Dec 2017	**Ridelink,** *Technical Lead* Led a polyglot team building a car-sharing platform, mainly in PHP (Symfony, Silex) with some Go and Python services. Designed and deployed AWS infrastructure with ECS, SQS, SNS, RDS, ElastiCache and Elasticsearch. Built and open-sourced deploy-ecs, a CLI that automates continuous deployments across environments.

🎓 Education

Jun 2011	**UNIVALI University,** *BSc in Computer Engineering*